

GMUNC XII

Napolean's

Cabinet

Axel Clouin • Head Chair
Iris Blanchet • Co-Chair



About Chairs

Axel Clouin · Head Chair

Hi everyone! I'm Axel Clouin and I'll be your Head Chair for this crisis committee. I'm a Sophomore at Gunn High School and I've been doing MUN for 3 years now. Outside of MUN, I enjoy playing badminton, tetris, and drinking boba! I really love MUN because of the collaboration between different delegates, the quick thinking required for crisis committees, and the thinking outside the box to resolve difficult situations. I hope you all have as much fun in our crisis committee as we had making it and keep the atmosphere interesting and ever changing. Since this is a beginner conference we'll try to keep the crisis updates not too complex, but don't worry there will be plenty of opportunities to create deep crisis arcs for more experienced delegates. I'm excited to see all the incredible ideas you bring to committee, and don't hesitate to reach out if you have any questions!

P.S. For legal reasons take most of what Iris says as a joke ;)

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Iris Blanchet · Co-Chair

Greetings folks. Iris Blanchet here (she/her), coming at you LIVE from GMUNC XII. I'm currently a senior at Henry M. Gunn High School and this is my second year doing MUN. This is also my first time co-chairing a committee! Even though I've only been here for a short time, I'm sure you guys will love the monstrosity of a committee we created, Axel worked really hard on it (I was listening to Foo Fighters and doodling most of the time (for legal reasons that's a joke)). In my spare time I love religiously watching Community and The Daily Show, hoarding Family Guy DVDs, volunteering for different service opportunities in Palo Alto, and watching Mexico lose yet another football game to Argentina. My favorite MUN committee's gotta be crisis ones cause of all the chaos that can happen. And yeah this conference is gonna be pretty chill for the most part since it's for beginners, but don't worry, as your crisis director I've got some crazy stuff I've been cooking up, also if you guys make it chaotic I sure as hell won't mind (cause that's gonna win you best del in my book (for legal reasons that's a joke)). Be sure to reach out if you have any questions!

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About Committee

The purpose of this committee is to serve as both an introductory crisis committee to beginners and to allow collaboration and creative thinking from experienced delegates. As Napoleon's cabinet, it's you against the rest of Europe, make sure to have fun and no matter how badly you mess up you can't get exiled more than twice, right?

Important Dates

Oct 4, 2024 - Research award deadline

Oct 10, 2024 - Final position paper deadline

Oct 11, 2024 - Day of conference

Committee Email

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Foreword

Welcome to the Gunn Model United Nations Conference XII and Napoleon's Cabinet crisis committee. Having previously attended GMUNC, I am honored to be a part of this conference again and excited for another memorable year.

This committee simulates what it is like to be at the forefront of a war where all odds are against you. You will have to work closely with other delegates to carefully maneuver through the danger that is wartime politics, for if you do not, the French Empire and its revolutionary ideals will cease to exist. Since this is a crisis committee, crisis updates will occur and all writing will be done in the form of crisis notes and directives.

Position papers are due on October 4 to be considered for a research award, with the final deadline on October 10. If you do not submit a position paper by this date, you will not be eligible for any committee awards. Additionally, keep in mind we may not be able to give you position paper feedback if you submit it last minute. Please send position papers and committee-specific inquiries to the committee email address: gmuncxiinapoleon@gmail.com. Additionally, all delegates are required to complete contact and medical forms to participate in the conference. Please confirm with your delegation that the required documents have been submitted.

I wish you the best with writing your position papers and look forward to seeing everyone on October 11, 2025 for GMUNC XII.

Axel Clouin
Head Chair



Introduction

There's always something else you can do

The year is 1805. With the French Empire at a crossroads due to a complex military strategy. If it succeeds, it may usher in an era of French dominance over Europe; if it fails it may spell the end of the French Empire.

French allies and ostensibly neutral countries in Europe remain on the fence, not daring to question the might of the Grande Armée

...for now. As members of Napoleon's inner circle, you'll work to navigate diplomacy, manage crises, and make decisions that could save...or doom... the Empire.



Historical Context

In 1789, the Storming of the Bastille occurred, signaling the beginning of the French Revolution, a revolution that completely shifted the continental zeitgeist about what peasants were capable of doing. Neighboring nations could only watch in horror as the



monarchy was overthrown and replaced by the National Assembly, for intervention would have resulted in many casualties. Eventually the revolution grew too terrifying and fearing the worst for

their fellow monarch, Emperor Leopold II (Holy Roman Empire) and King Frederick William II (Prussia) issued the Declaration of Pillnitz in 1791, which stated that if any harm were to befall the French king, the HRE and Prussia would respond with military force. This declaration was mostly an empty threat and ended up having the opposite effect they desired. At this point, the main reason other Monarchies had only watched the French Revolution from afar was because they assumed that the King would gain power again or that they'd all kill themselves. When neither of these outcomes occurred many countries worried that the radical ideals of the revolution would spread to their nations. These high tensions, along with the French National Assembly's belief Austria and Prussia would invade them and the Radicals'

desire to spread Revolutionary ideas to other countries, led France to declare war on Austria in 1792. This war is known as the "War of the First Coalition" and as the name implies there would be many more wars to follow.

In April of 1792, Charles William Ferdinand Duke of Brunswick invaded France at a slow but steady pace. He also issued the Brunswick manifesto which stated anyone who stood in the way of the reinstatement of Louis the XVI as ruler of France would be killed. French forces attempted to push back the advancing Duke but they failed as fortress after fortress fell to Prussian hands. These advancements caused many riots in France such as the September Massacre which saw over 1,000 Parisians killed. Eventually French Army Generals Dumouriez and Kellerman stopped the Prussian forces and forced them to retreat at the Battle of Valmy. This victory was followed by many others leading the French to defeat the Austrians at the Battle of Jemappes, and Dumouriez essentially had control over the whole country.



(September Massacres)

Soon thereafter France had declared war on Prussia, Austria, Britain, Spain and the Dutch Republic. Portugal, Naples, and the HRE soon joined this Anti-France coalition and France found themselves in quite the pickle. The victorious sentiment created by the defeat of the Austrians was short-lived as the French began losing battles almost unilaterally across their borders. At one of these battles, The Battle of Neerwinden, an Austrian victory led to Dumouriez defecting to the Austrians, leaving France virtually leaderless. If France didn't do something quickly the entire country would likely crumble. So, the Committee of Public Safety was founded in April 1793 and they were given near-dictatorial control over the state. With their new power, the Committee of Public Safety decided to save the public by killing 30-40,000 citizens and terrifying the general public in the aptly named Reign of Terror. The Committee then made all men aged 18-25 available for military conscription, and by September 1794, French armies totaled over one million soldiers making it the largest in Europe. Many other military reforms occurred, resulting in a highly efficient and powerful French army.

Meanwhile, quite the opposite was happening for the Allied army. Some poor decisions such as: dividing their armies, besieging every fortress on the way to Paris, and communications issues, resulted in potent French counter-attacks. Throughout the end of 1793 and the beginning of 1794,

France won numerous battles, greatly demoralizing the Austrians, who decided the Netherlands was not worth defending. Using the frozen rivers during the winter, the French captured Belgium and the Netherlands in January of 1795. France then converted these nations into the Bavarian Republic, the first of France's "sister republics" (sister republics were territories outside of France that were indirectly controlled by France, similar to colonies). The French succeeded in punching back invaders elsewhere as well, notably at the Siege of Toulon, where Napoleon Bonaparte's victory launched his career. Later that year Prussia and Spain withdrew from the war after suffering considerable losses, with Prussia giving up the left bank of the Rhineland in the Treaty of Basel. Britain however, didn't give up and launched various naval assaults against French forces until they attempted an invasion of northern France in June of 1795. This invasion was unsuccessful however, and resulted in a loss at the Battle of Quiberon. Austria, being France's final foe in this war attacked French forces in the Rhineland and successfully repulsed them, dealing a major blow to France. This loss was not their greatest concern however, as the new government called "The French Directory" was running out of money quickly. This forced French forces to rely on the land for food and supplies, resulting in the pillaging of cities in northern Italy and the Rhineland. French generals would also extort exorbitant amounts of money from cities and steal art

and artifacts. This changed the perception of France from benevolent liberators to horrible oppressors.

In 1796 and 1797 France still wasn't willing to back away from the Rhineland and planned on capturing and capturing Vienna, the Austrian capital, through Germany. So the French sent two armies under General Jourdan and General Moreau as the main attack and General Bonaparte, the man of average stature for his time, was sent as a distraction to go through northern Italy. Bonaparte's army was notably under-resourced and had to live off the land for virtually everything. However, this was a benefit in disguise, for the lack of supplies meant they had much less to carry, resulting in astonishing speed. This speed and Bonaparte's excellent strategic planning allowed his army to split up the armies of Piedmont-Sardinia and Austria. And while Jourdan and Moreau's offensive was badly defeated, Bonaparte defeated the Sardinians and Austrians in turn. He then captured Naples and laid siege to Mantua. The distraction mission soon became France's last hope and Napoleon did not disappoint. Battle after battle resulted in French victory and Napoleon established a multitude of Italian sister republics all over Northern Italy.



Eventually, when he was only 100 miles away from Vienna, the Austrians asked for an Armistice, and the Treaty of Campo Formio, signed on October 17th of 1797, signaled the end of the War of the First Coalition. Against all odds the French had won!

Now, if you had thought France would take a break after the last five years of constant war you would've been correct. They took a pause of precisely 3 months. In September of 1797 just a month before the end of the War of the First Coalition, the extreme Jacobin party staged a coup, arresting the conservative and monarchist members of the French Directory. This new Fructidorian Directory, as it was called, decided they should continue the spread of revolutionary ideals and territorial conquest. So, in January of 1798 the Swiss government was overthrown in a coup and another sister republic was instated under the name "The Helvetic Republic". In Rome, the death of a French general during a riot served as the reason for an invasion of the papal states. And by just the 15th of February 1798 France

had added another state to its 'collection' of sister republics. Next up on their list of enemies was Britain but France realized a full scale invasion would likely go terribly so Talleyrand, a popular military general proposed the idea to take over Egypt in order to attack British Indian territories.

At first the invasion went successfully with the capture of Malta (June 10th), the occupation of Alexandria (July 2nd), and a victory over the ruling Mamluks and the Battle of the Pyramids (July 21st). For Napoleon Bonaparte, this was especially good, as his military popularity grew with each victory. However such success was short lived as the British squadron of Horatio Nelson soon arrived in Egypt and the subsequent Battle of the Nile resulted in the death of over half of Bonaparte's forces. Even worse, in September, the Ottoman Empire declared war on France and began preparing forces in Syria to reclaim Egypt. With France weakened, many European countries decided it would be the perfect opportunity to reclaim lost territory and pride. One of the most eager people to declare war on France was Emperor Paul I of Russia. Even though Russia was neutral in the War of the First Coalition, Paul was infuriated that France removed the Knights of Saint John from rule of Malta. So, Emperor Paul decided to form a new anti-France alliance consisting of Russia, Austria, Portugal, The Ottoman Empire, and Naples. And so began the War of the Second Coalition.



Right off the bat, Naples, empowered by its participation in the Alliance, decided to invade the Roman republic in order to restore the papal states. However, they forget to communicate their invasion to any other nations and arrive in Rome outnumbered. Wasting no time, France squashes the Neapolitan invasion and conquers Naples, instating the Parthenopean republic. The war was not off to a great start for the anti-France Alliance. Now, even with Naples out of the way they still had very powerful enemies. So, the Directory called for the mass conscription of all unmarried men between 20-25 to fill the ranks of three armies. General Jourdan led an army in the Rhine, General Masséna led one in Switzerland, and General Schérer led one in Italy. In Germany, Austria was waiting for Russian reinforcements before attacking Jourdan, so Jourdan, despite being outnumbered 3 to 1, decided it would be the perfect time to strike. Archduke Charles who was leading the Austrian army thoroughly decimates Jourdan's army, so badly in fact that after retreating across the Rhine he resigned his position.

Things weren't much better in Switzerland and Italy. Though Masséna won the First Battle of Zurich, he understood his army wouldn't survive a second assault and so he retreated to a better defensive line along the Limmat river. In Italy Schérer attacked Austrian forces in the Battle of Magnano, and after losing 8,000 men, he too was forced to retreat back into French territory. The Austrians chased after them, accompanied by a Russian expeditionary force led by Alexander Suvorov, and defeated the French once more at the Battle of Cassano on the 27th of April 1799. The following day, Schérer was replaced with Moreau as the Austro-Russian army entered Milan unopposed. Moreau decided to fall back to Genoa and ordered a French army under General Macdonald to meet him there. Along his way, Macdonald was intercepted by Suvorov and defeated in the Battle of Trebbia. This was the high point of Russia's Italy Campaign. However, instead of taking the opportunity to annihilate the remaining French forces and push into France, Suvorov was ordered to finish taking over Italy by Austria. Suvorov dutifully complied and laid siege to Mantua and Piedmont; conquering the country. Macdonald was replaced by General Joubert, who promised he wouldn't disappoint France, but disappoint he did. He attacked Suvorov at the Battle of Novi (15th of August), and he quickly died, along with over 11,000 men from his army. This was Suvorov's last battle in Italy however as he

had another disagreement with the Austrian government. He wanted to liberate the states while Austria wanted governmental power over them since they had done most of the fighting. Eventually Suvorov was removed from Italy and Austria got what they wanted.



Meanwhile, Russia and Britain decided to invade Holland in order to force French troops away from Switzerland and Italy. On the 27th of August 1799, the invasion began; led by Prince Francis Augustus of York, the goal was to dismantle the Batavian republic and restore the Prince of Orange to the throne. However, York's advance was quickly halted by intense flooding, rampant disease, inadequate food, and a lack of expected aid from the locals. The Dutch-French army finished off the remaining Ruso-British soldiers at the Battle of Bergen and the Battle of Castricum, forcing York to sign the convention of Alkmaar, allowing any remaining troops to evacuate. Following this victory, Masséna fought the Allies once more

at the Second Battle of Zurich and this time the Allies faced an even more crushing defeat. The army was shattered, decimated, and with their general dead.

This left France in a much better position at the end of 1799 than the beginning, but the war was not over. And frankly, the French were tired of the way the Directory was handling the war, so as the French often do, they planned a revolutionary coup to attempt to completely reorganize the government. A crucial part of this coup was our old friend Napoleon. Now, if you remember we last left Napoleon when he was fighting in Egypt, and soon after we left him he left his army to fend for themselves. However, since he was the only "reputable" source to return, he told everyone his campaign was a success. This "military expertise" made him the perfect candidate for rule in the eyes of two gentlemen. Talleyrand and Siyès had been planning to overthrow the Directory for quite some time and had just been waiting for a leader to rule the nation in its stead. So, on the 9th of November, 1799, Bonaparte seized control of the government in what is called the Coup of 18 Brumaire, and established himself as First Consul.

In spring of 1800 Bonaparte put Moreau in charge of the Army in Germany and he personally took charge of the Italian front. With his excellent strategy and predictions, he was able to narrowly wrestle victory from Austria at the Battle of Marengo and sent

them retreating even further. This loss, accompanied by Moreau's own success at the Battle of Hohenlinden, was apparently the straw that broke the camel as once again, Austria surrendered to France and signed the Treaty of Lunéville on February 9th 1801. Emperor Paul, frustrated with the failures of his allies, also decided it would be best to pull out of the war and reconcile with France. He was assassinated soon after in March and Russia officially formalized peace with France in October of 1801. This war, though lacking many it began with, was not yet over; there remained the British. They blockaded French ports, attacked French trading vessels, and annihilated the remains of the French army stationed in Egypt. This did not go well with the French however who allied with numerous other nations and embargoed Britain right back. They eventually agreed to peace as both their economies were pretty screwed and signed the Treaty of Amiens on March 25th, 1802.



At this point France was struggling, their economy was a mess, their government was

constantly changing, and the constant war didn't help. So, it was time Napoleon showed his people if he could not only lead an army, but also a country. And he sure delivered; he reformed currency, created a new national bank, and improved taxation and welfare systems. He also consolidated all the complicated contradictory French laws and constitutions into a new "Napoleonic Code". He also removed corrupt officials from government, made the education system more merit based and did many other social, political, and economic reforms. This made him extraordinarily popular and allowed him to instate himself as Emperor on December 2nd 1804 without getting his head cut off, which is quite the achievement for a French ruler.

However, as France was still in Europe, war was right around the corner. Both France and Britain had been violating the Treaty of Amiens for months and neither side was happy about it. On March 18th, 1803, Britain declared war. Bonaparte reacted with speed, and quickly occupied Hanover. Additionally, he set up a military base in Boulogne and stationed over 120,000 men to fight. But France was not alone in their preparations; Britain called on the powers of Europe to form a third coalition, but this time they were less enthusiastic to join in. They had already lost to France twice and weren't too keen on trying again. That is, however, until Napoleon violated the neutral sovereignty of Baden and kidnapped and killed the Duke of Enghien.

This horrified the greater European nations. So, they said "Third times the charm" and Russia, Naples, Austria, Sweden, and Sicily all joined Britain. The War of the Third Coalition was underfoot.



Current Situation

The French Empire stands at a crossroads.

It is mid-July, and the War of the Third Coalition is grinding into a dangerous phase. Napoleon Bonaparte is still stationed in Boulogne with the Grande Armée and is orchestrating a bold and complex plan that he hopes will strike a decisive blow to the British Empire, a transatlantic naval strategy involving French and Spanish fleets sailing to the Caribbean to draw out the Royal Navy, clearing the English Channel and allowing an invasion force to cross. However, the execution of this plan has already begun to falter. Delays, poor coordination, and the presence of genius and madman Admiral Horatio Nelson have raised serious doubts among those in Paris on the viability of Napoleon's plan. The Atlantic gambit may still succeed, or it may collapse entirely and leave France exposed and humiliated.

Meanwhile, on the continent, the war continues on multiple fronts as France is officially at war with Britain, Austria, and Russia. As well, ostensibly neutral Prussia may soon be lured into the fray in an attempt to regain lost territory and prestige. While the Kingdom of Italy remains firmly under French influence, the instability of the region is making it harder and harder to govern. Armed uprisings or foreign-backed coups remain a real possibility if France appears to weaken. In the south, Spain, a nominal ally of France since the Treaty of San Ildefonso, appears increasingly unstable due to longstanding

financial difficulties. While their navy is committed to supporting France's continued efforts at sea to defeat the British, losses and mismanagement coupled with a weak monarch have weakened Spanish resolve. A decisive victory at sea at the hands of the British could cause the alliance to unravel quickly.

Back in Paris, the atmosphere is tense. While Napoleon's authority remains undisputed, there is unease that his increasingly ambitious military campaigns will soon fail spectacularly. His ministers must now shoulder a growing burden, forced to balance the need to execute the Emperor's complex military designs, and manage the growing domestic unrest regarding the ongoing wars. If Napoleon were to suffer an unfortunate incident, it is they who would be tasked with holding the Empire together.

Goals for Committee

- Defend Paris from the invading Austrian and Russian armies
- Suppress internal rebellions and keep them from growing
- Prevent additional powers from joining the Coalition
- Decide how best to maintain French stability and cohesion
- Rebuild French prestige over the continent

Questions to Consider

- What is the key issue being discussed?
- How do these issues specifically affect your character? Why does this matter to the person you represent?
- What challenges do you anticipate facing?
- How can the problems be solved?

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